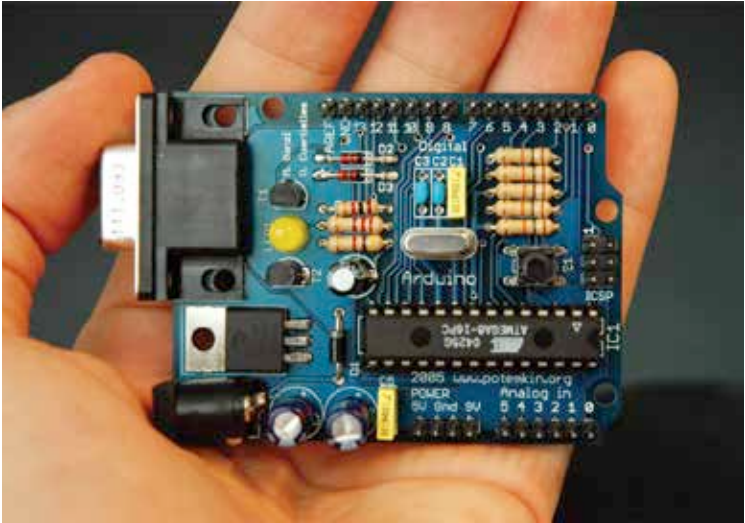




An early Arduino Board

electronics quickly and easily. Back in 2002, Students were still relying on the BASIC stamp which was both inadequate for many purposes and was quite expensive at 100\$. Due to budget cuts and other constraints, Banzi had to figure a way to teach his students economically.

His student, Hernando Barragan, was the one to develop Wiring with the goal of creating a language with the programming ease of Processing with the end result being programming a microcontroller instead of graphics on a screen. It was a promising development and still continues to be used today. But at that point of time, Banzi was still not okay with the state of things. He wanted to make it simpler, easier, and cheaper.

The team decided to take the open source route further and set for themselves the student friendly goal of 30\$ pricing. The first prototype that they built used cheap and easily available components like the ATmega328 microcontroller (20MHz, 32KB, 23I/O Pins), but their first priority was ease of use. Essentially they wanted it be more like 'plug-and-play', which anyone would connect to their PC through something as common as a USB cable and start programming it without adding anything to the original cost. It didn't take much time for word of Arduino to spread, and the rest is right in front of us. Arduino has almost democratized Engineering single handed by enabling a lot of people to create products themselves.